

Working with FrontPage

Microsoft FrontPage is a Web designing software that offers a WYSIWYG (what-you-see-is-what-you-get) effect. Start with a new file from **File > New**. Give an attractive heading, say, 'Welcome to my Web Abode'. Select the text and right-click to set the theme for the page. Select from various effects such as banners, artsy, blends, blueprint effects, etc. The Modify button allows you to change the graphics, colours and text. Next, list the topics you wish to cover about your business, say, company history, achievements, mission statement, sister concerns, company news, and services offered. You can create links for every topic by selecting it and right-clicking for the hyperlink option. All you need to do is enter the name of the file for the link to the page where the details are provided.

Using tables helps to organise the elements on your Web page and facilitates downloads. Just choose the **Table > Insert Table** option from the menu bar. Enter the number of rows and columns for your table. The Insert menu offers plenty of options such as components (hit-counters, hover button, marquee, banner-ad manager, scheduled pictures, etc), forms (checkboxes, text fields, radio buttons, scrolling text box, drop-down menu, etc), and advanced features such as plugins, ActiveX controls, Java applets, etc. It is easy to embed Flash files in your document. Create your .swf and .html files and then copy and paste both the files in the page field of your html editor.

build your own site. Professionals could charge up to Rs 50,000 to design a fairly comprehensive site. This usually includes the cost of the designing and programming involved.

If you decide to do this all by yourself then creating your own Web site will entail a major investment of your time, energy and patience.

A lot of the free Web hosting services offer you Web-based wizards that can help you build your site. All the options for page designing, hosting, and uploading are available through simple clicks. If you have created your own Flash or JPEG files, you can add your own look to the standard design templates available on the sites of these free Web space providers.

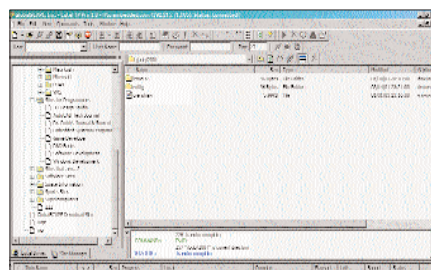
Doing this all by yourself would involve learning how to use a host of designing applications such as Macromedia Dreamweaver, Microsoft Frontpage, Adobe Photoshop, Macromedia Fireworks, Adobe Imageready and Macromedia Flash. Most of these applications can take a while for newcomers to get a hang of.

Be careful that you don't go overboard with those fancy images or you may end up with a page that downloads at a snail's pace. You need to consider the space your site would occupy and the size of each page. You can optimise your graphics images by using the 'Save for Web' option in most imaging software. The GIF and JPEG formats are most popular for simple graphics on the Web.

Ensure that the images and the content are appropriately designed for your site. "I had to work a lot on the logo for my site. In fact, it took me a whole week to get that formal look that is so crucial for a business-oriented Web site," says Anup.

Using CuteFTP

The entire process involves typing in your host name (ftp.yourhostname.com), user ID and password with the host where your Web site resides, and then dragging the index.html (main page) and all other relevant files and folders from your local disk to your space on the server. After you have all the relevant files ready to be uploaded, you simply have to click on the option indicated by an up-arrow sign to transfer your files from your local disk to your server on the Web.



"Designing is not just about using sophisticated applications—you have to use them the right way and for a genuine purpose. The site should have the right 'look and feel' to be able to hold the visitor's attention," says Sunando Banerji, who works at Netguru.com.

Launch pad

Now that your Web site is ready, you need to upload it onto the World Wide Web. For free Web site providers such as Geocities.com and freeservers.com, you can simply upload the files using their Web-based file manager. It allows you to browse for the files on your hard disk that can then be uploaded to the server by clicking a single button.

A more efficient solution could be using one of the numerous FTP clients that allow you to transfer files via a Windows Explorer-like interface. In fact, Windows 98 allows you to use Explorer to transfer files via FTP.

However, a dedicated FTP client would offer you a lot of features such as the resume function that can be quite useful. CuteFTP is one of the simplest and most popular applications for uploading files onto the Net but others like FTP-pro and WS_FTP are quite proficient too. "FTP-pro is a very user-friendly and reliable FTP client and I have been using it for quite a long time now," offers Sunando.

Spreading the word

Once your site is up and running, you will probably want to publicise it by registering your domain name with the more popular search engines such as yahoo.com, altavista.com, google.com, webcrawler.com, lycos.com, and infoseek.com. You can submit your site to these search engines for free. Log on to www.searchengines.com/urlsubmission.html for more information about search engines on the Net. The other option is to use software such as